

Windows Is Not Windows

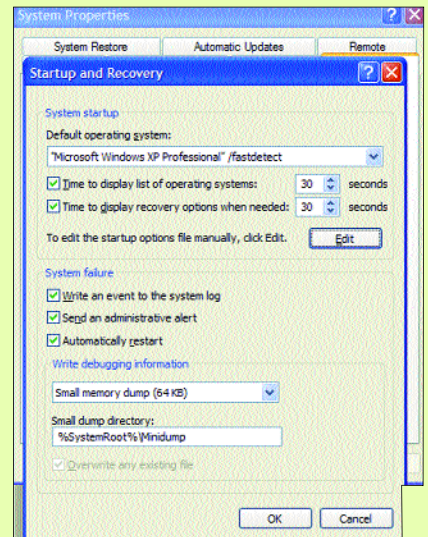
Q I copied the Windows XP SP2 final file from the *Digit* September 2004 DVD. When I tried to run it, the application extracts all the files but then displays "The core system file (Kernel) used to start this computer is not a Microsoft Windows file. The service pack will not be installed." Setup then aborts. How can I install SP2? I have a Pentium III 1.14 GHz and 256 MB of SDRAM running Windows 98 and XP Professional.

Ram Kishore

A This happens when your computer has a modified version of the Ntldr.exe file that uses the /KERNEL switch in the Boot.ini file. This is due to a third-party application, such as BootXP or LogonUI Boot Randomiser, which customises the graphics that are displayed when your computer starts up.

To solve this problem, go to Start>Run, type in "appwiz.cpl" and press [Enter]. Select the program name you installed that customises startup graphics, and click 'Remove'.

Now restart your PC and try and install SP2. If this still doesn't work, press [Windows] + [Pause/Break] and go to the Advanced tab and click on the 'Settings' button under 'Startup and Recovery'. Under 'System Startup', click 'Edit'—this will open the 'boot.ini' file in Notepad. Locate and delete the line containing "/KERNEL =", and save and close the boot.ini file. Restart the computer, and you should be able to install SP2.



Here's where you edit the startup options file

QUESTION
OF THE
MONTH

Modem Madness

Q I own an AMD 2400+ based PC with an Asus motherboard and 256 MB of DDR RAM. Recently, I installed XP and a modem (Motorola SM65). I didn't have the XP drivers for it, so I installed the Windows 2000 drivers. My PC restarted just as the installation was about to complete. It kept restarting during the POST period. I thought it was a hardware problem, so I removed the modem, and the PC started.

I then downloaded the XP drivers, and again put on the modem. This time the PC started—then, just as I was installing the drivers, the PC restarted yet again, and it kept restarting until I disconnected the modem. Is this a hardware problem? If so, why does it happen only after I try installing the drivers?

Via E-mail

A Download your modem drivers from the Motorola Web site at <http://snipurl.com/dd6v>. Now, go to My Computer>Properties. Under the 'Hardware' tab, click on 'Device Manager'; your modem should be listed. Click and uninstall it completely. Reboot your PC and re-install the modem. If the problem persists, try installing the modem on a different computer; if it installs there, then you need to extract your modem driver files into a folder, go to 'Device Manager', select your modem, and under the 'Driver' tab, click 'Update Driver'. Give the location as that of the folder into which you extracted your drivers. It should work now.

The Sound Of Linux

Q I have a Pentium III 800 MHz with 256 MB of SDRAM. I also have an Xwave QS3000A PCI sound card. The problem is my sound card does not work under Red Hat Linux 9.0. I have

searched and asked all the technicians I know for various solutions, but none seems to be working. Is there any way I can use my sound card with Linux, or will I need to go in for a new one?

Sanjeev Prakash

A Red Hat Linux 9 by default does not come with bundled drivers for your particular make of sound card. But your Linux-specific drivers are available at www.alsa-project.org. Download the following from the main page: library, utilities and tools. Now, uncompress the files and recompile the Linux kernel with the new drivers. Your sound card should work now.

Partitioning Woes

Q I have a Pentium 4 3.2 GHz processor with 512 MB of DDR RAM and an 80 GB HDD. I have been using Windows 98, and now want to install Windows XP Pro. I would also like to keep Windows 98. However, my hard disk is not partitioned, and I do not want to format it. Is there a way to partition a disk without formatting it? Or, can Windows XP and 98 SE be installed on the same partition?

Nitesh Kumar

A You can install Windows XP and 98 on the same partition by specifying different installation folders. This, however, can lead to various conflicts as the two OSes use entirely different drivers and system file versions. The best way to do it is to install the OSes on different partitions.

One of the best softwares that will let you accomplish this is Partition Magic 8.0. You can download it from <http://snipurl.com/cbdk>.

Note that you will need to purchase the software, as the demo version only shows you the partition creating process and will not actually create any partitions. ■

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